

D740

Student Teaching II in Special Education

Armored Drill

8 concepts · 12 items · 4 transfer items

What this is. Every concept in this course's public description, re-asked with more disguise than a practice test uses. Each stem carries facts that do not decide it. Every wrong answer is a named trap.

Source. Scope from the course's public description in the WGU Institutional Catalog (September 2026); items written from the field's standard body of knowledge. No WGU assessment item, course material or proprietary content is used or reproduced. Not affiliated with or endorsed by Western Governors University.

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How to run it

Paper first. Pencil. One pass, no notes, a timer if you want the pressure.

1. **Before you read the options**, fill the strip under the item: the target word (what is actually being asked), and the one fact in the stem that decides it.
2. **Principle before arithmetic**. Name the rule, then compute.
3. **Camouflage**. Most of every stem does not matter. Ask: which single fact decides this?
4. **Inverse pairs are the bait**. If two options are opposites, one of them is the trap built for you.
5. **Mark sure, unsure or guess** honestly. Sure-and-wrong is the most valuable miss on the page — it is a wrong mental model.
6. **Absolutes** (always, never, guarantee) are usually wrong. And recognizing an answer is not the same as owning it.
7. Items with a **heavy black bar** on the left are **transfer items**: the same principle, reversed or solved for a different variable.
8. Stop at the STOP page. Then grade, fill the triage grid, and tally the traps you fell for. The biggest tally is what you drill next.

The strip, filled in, looks like this:

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	_____	

Items

1.

A candidate in a resource room works with a fourth grader who has a learning disability in reading. The school just adopted a new literacy program, and the student's mother volunteers in the library on Fridays. The general education teacher already gives the student extra time on tests. Which action by the candidate is specially designed instruction?

- A. Using the new literacy program exactly as written for the whole class.
- B. Asking the mother to read with the student during library time.
- C. Giving the student extra time on the weekly reading test.
- D. Teaching decoding with an explicit, systematic sequence and extra guided practice matched to the student's errors.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

2. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A team lists four supports for a student. Which one is an accommodation, not specially designed instruction?

- A. None of these, because any support written in an IEP is SDI.
- B. Pre-teaching key vocabulary with picture supports before each unit.
- C. Having test directions read aloud.
- D. Daily small-group lessons using a scripted, explicit math intervention.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

3.

A seventh grader with an emotional disability rarely finishes written summaries in class. The candidate notices the student wears headphones between classes and loves graphic novels. When the candidate offered ten minutes of computer time for a finished summary, the student wrote a complete, accurate summary in fifteen minutes. What should the candidate conclude first?

- A. The student needs graphic novels for all written work.
- B. The student will never work without a reward.
- C. It is a performance deficit, so the focus should be on motivation and conditions, not reteaching summarizing.
- D. It is a skill deficit, so summarizing should be retaught from the beginning.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

4. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A student cannot solve two-step equations even when offered a strong reward and a quiet setting. What kind of deficit is this, and what should the teacher do?

- A.** No deficit, since the setting was quiet.
- B.** A skill deficit; teach the skill directly with modeling and guided practice.
- C.** A behavior problem; apply a consequence for not working.
- D.** A performance deficit; increase the reward.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

5.

A third grader with autism often pushes away math worksheets but can solve the problems when working one-on-one. The class is decorated with a space theme, and the student's older brother attends the same school. The candidate wants a first, low-effort change. Which change best uses choice-making?

- A.** Let the student choose between a whiteboard or the worksheet, and which five problems to do first.
- B.** Move the student to sit near the brother's classroom.
- C.** Remove all math worksheets from the student's day.
- D.** Let the student choose whether to do math or free time.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

6.

Two days before an annual IEP meeting, a parent who owns a busy restaurant downtown gives the candidate a \$150 gift card and says, "I hope you'll push for the extra aide." The candidate's cooperating teacher has worked at the school for nineteen years. What should the candidate do?

- A.** Accept it but vote against the aide to prove neutrality.
- B.** Ask the cooperating teacher to hold it until after the meeting.
- C.** Politely decline the gift and tell the cooperating teacher and supervisor about the exchange.
- D.** Accept it, since gift cards are not cash.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

7.

Late in student teaching, a candidate who commutes forty minutes each way says, “I feel empty by lunch, and honestly my caseload is just a list of problems now.” The candidate’s lesson scores have stayed high. Which interpretation fits best?

- A. These are early burnout signs, exhaustion and depersonalization, and should be addressed now with support and boundaries.
- B. The commute is the cause, so moving closer will solve it.
- C. There is no concern, because the lesson scores are high.
- D. This is normal professional distance that shows growing experience.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

8. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

Which statement from a teacher is the clearest sign of the depersonalization part of burnout?

- A. “Nothing I do seems to make a difference anymore.”
- B. “They’re just files to me now; I stop caring what happens to them.”
- C. “I leave work at work and protect my weekends.”
- D. “I’m so tired I can barely get out of bed on Mondays.”

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

9.

A candidate finishing licensure wants to keep improving at teaching students with complex communication needs. Her district offers a free yoga class and three required compliance trainings each fall. Which plan best builds ongoing professional growth?

- A. Ask her cooperating teacher to plan her learning for the next five years.
- B. Attend one national conference and consider the topic learned.
- C. Complete the three required compliance trainings each fall.
- D. Join a professional organization’s AAC interest group, follow a few trusted practitioners, and bring questions from her own students to them.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

10.

A candidate wants to test a new self-graphing fluency routine with a fifth grader who reads 62 words correct per minute. The student's favorite subject is science and he plays soccer after school. Which plan lets the candidate judge whether the routine works?

- A. Take several baseline probes, start only the new routine, keep probing the same way, and compare level and trend.
- B. Start the routine today and check one probe in a month.
- C. Switch his fluency passages to science topics and use soccer as the reward.
- D. Start the routine, a new reading book, and a reward chart the same day, then probe weekly.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

11. [TRANSFER — reversed stem / different variable]

A candidate's AB data show baseline scores of 20, 21, 20, 21 and intervention scores of 20, 21, 21, 20. What is the best conclusion?

- A. The method works, because scores stayed high.
- B. Collect baseline again, since baseline data are useless once intervention starts.
- C. The method will never work for this student.
- D. The method has not changed performance yet, so adjust or replace it.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

12.

A candidate teaches a math unit on decimals to high school students with intellectual disabilities. The unit falls in March, right after the school's spring concert, and two students recently joined from another state. Which lesson plan best embeds a functional skill?

- A. Students skip decimals and only practice counting coins.
- B. Students compare prices on real grocery flyers and decide if \$10.00 covers a short list.
- C. Students complete a decimal worksheet, then practice money in a separate afternoon life-skills block.
- D. Students write a report about the spring concert.

Target word	The one fact that decides	Answer	[] sure [] unsure [] guess
_____	_____	___	

STOP

Answers and dissection follow. Finish every item and every strip first.

Key and dissection

Struck-through text is the camouflage: facts that do not decide the item.

1. Answer D Concept 1

A candidate in a resource room works with a fourth grader who has a learning disability in reading. ~~The school just adopted a new literacy program, and the student's mother volunteers in the library on Fridays.~~ The general education teacher already gives the student extra time on tests. Which action by the candidate is specially designed instruction?

Target word: which action counts as SDI **Decides:** SDI changes how the skill is taught to address the disability.

A	Confusion set	Core instruction for everyone is not individualized; SDI adapts it to the student's needs.
B	Camouflage	Uses the volunteering detail; family reading is support, not instruction designed by the teacher.
C	Adjacent category	Extra time is an accommodation; it changes access, not instruction.
D	Correct	Adapting the method and delivery of instruction to the disability-related need is SDI.

2. Answer C Concept 1 · transfer

A team lists four supports for a student. Which one is an accommodation, not specially designed instruction?

Target word: reverse: pick the non-SDI support **Decides:** Accommodations change access or format, not the teaching method.

A	Absolute language	IEPs list both SDI and accommodations; they are different categories.
B	Confusion set	Pre-teaching with adapted delivery is specially designed instruction.
C	Correct	Read-aloud directions change access; nothing about the instruction is redesigned.
D	Inverted operation	That is SDI: the method and delivery are adapted.

3. Answer C Concept 2

A seventh grader with an emotional disability rarely finishes written summaries in class. ~~The candidate notices the student wears headphones between classes and loves graphic novels.~~ When the candidate offered ten minutes of computer time for a finished summary, the student wrote a complete, accurate summary in fifteen minutes. What should the candidate conclude first?

Target word: type of deficit **Decides:** The student produced the skill when motivated.

A	Camouflage	Uses the interest detail; interests may help, but they do not identify the type of deficit.
B	Absolute language	Rewards can be faded; one test with an incentive does not predict never.
C	Correct	The skill appeared with an incentive, so the student can do it; the issue is doing it.
D	Inverted operation	Flips the finding; a skill deficit means the student cannot do it even when motivated.

4. Answer B Concept 2 • transfer

A student cannot solve two-step equations even when offered a strong reward and a quiet setting. What kind of deficit is this, and what should the teacher do?

Target word: reverse: evidence of a skill deficit **Decides:** The skill does not appear even under ideal conditions.

A	Confusion set	The quiet setting was a condition that ruled out distraction, not proof of skill.
B	Correct	If a strong incentive does not produce the skill, the student needs instruction.
C	Adjacent category	Treats a missing skill as defiance.
D	Inverted operation	A reward already failed; motivation is not the barrier.

5. Answer A Concept 3

A third grader with autism often pushes away math worksheets but can solve the problems when working one-on-one. ~~The class is decorated with a space theme, and the student's older brother attends the same school.~~ The candidate wants a first, low-effort change. Which change best uses choice-making?

Target word: choice-making adjustment **Decides:** Choice must keep the goal and change how or in what order.

A	Correct	Choices about materials and order raise engagement while the math goal stays the same.
B	Camouflage	Uses the brother detail, which does not relate to the task.
C	Absolute language	Removing the task lowers expectations instead of increasing engagement.
D	Dropped element	Drops the academic goal; the choice is about the task itself, not how to do it.

6. Answer C Concept 4

Two days before an annual IEP meeting, a parent ~~who owns a busy restaurant downtown~~ gives the candidate a \$150 gift card and says, "I hope you'll push for the extra aide." ~~The candidate's cooperating teacher has worked at the school for nineteen years.~~ What should the candidate do?

Target word: ethical response to a gift **Decides:** The gift has real value and is tied to a decision.

A	Inverted operation	Lets the gift drive the decision in the other direction; decisions must rest on the student's needs.
B	Camouflage	Leans on the teacher's experience; delaying acceptance does not fix a gift tied to a decision.
C	Correct	A valuable gift linked to an IEP decision is a conflict of interest; decline and report through proper channels.
D	Adjacent category	A gift card has cash value; the form of the gift does not remove the conflict.

7. Answer A Concept 5

Late in student teaching, a candidate ~~who commutes forty minutes each way~~ says, "I feel empty by lunch, and honestly my caseload is just a list of problems now." ~~The candidate's lesson scores have stayed high.~~ Which interpretation fits best?

Target word: recognize burnout **Decides:** Exhaustion plus depersonalized talk about students.

A	Correct	Two core burnout dimensions are present; early action prevents decline.
B	Dropped element	Ignores the depersonalization sign; one stressor does not explain the whole pattern.
C	Camouflage	Uses the scores; burnout can begin before performance falls.
D	Confusion set	Confuses healthy boundaries with cynicism toward students.

8. Answer B Concept 5 • transfer

Which statement from a teacher is the clearest sign of the depersonalization part of burnout?

Target word: reverse: from dimension to example **Decides:** Depersonalization is detached, cynical views of students.

A	Adjacent category	That is reduced sense of accomplishment.
B	Correct	Detached, cynical views of students define depersonalization.
C	Inverted operation	That is a healthy boundary, the opposite of burnout.
D	Confusion set	That is emotional exhaustion, a different dimension.

9. Answer D Concept 6

A candidate finishing licensure wants to keep improving at teaching students with complex communication needs. ~~Her district offers a free yoga class and three required compliance trainings each fall.~~ Which plan best builds ongoing professional growth?

Target word: sustained growth **Decides:** Growth comes from a network used to solve real practice problems.

A	Inverted operation	Puts ownership on someone else; a network is chosen and used by the teacher.
B	Absolute language	A one-time event does not sustain growth; learning must continue.
C	Camouflage	Required trainings meet rules but do not target her growth area.
D	Correct	A chosen network tied to real problems of practice supports continuous growth.

10. Answer A Concept 7

A candidate wants to test a new self-graphing fluency routine with a fifth grader who reads 62 words correct per minute. ~~The student's favorite subject is science and he plays soccer after school.~~ Which plan lets the candidate judge whether the routine works?

Target word: design to judge a new method **Decides:** Baseline first, then change only one thing.

A	Correct	An AB comparison with one change shows whether the routine is linked to growth.
B	Dropped element	Skips baseline and trend; one later score cannot show change.
C	Camouflage	Uses his interests; it changes other things instead of testing the routine.
D	Dropped element	Drops the one-change rule; any growth cannot be credited to the routine.

11. Answer D Concept 7 • transfer

A candidate's AB data show baseline scores of 20, 21, 20, 21 and intervention scores of 20, 21, 21, 20. What is the best conclusion?

Target word: read the result rather than design the test **Decides:** No change in level or trend between phases.

A	Inverted operation	Reads stable scores as gain; the intervention phase matches baseline.
B	Confusion set	Baseline is the comparison point; it is not discarded.
C	Absolute language	Four points justify an adjustment, not a permanent verdict.
D	Correct	Both phases are flat at about 20-21; there is no effect to keep.

12. Answer B Concept 8

A candidate teaches a math unit on decimals to high school students with intellectual disabilities. ~~The unit falls in March, right after the school's spring concert, and two students recently joined from another state.~~ Which lesson plan best embeds a functional skill?

Target word: functional skill inside academics **Decides:** Real materials that serve both the decimal standard and a life skill.

A	Dropped element	Drops the academic standard instead of connecting it.
B	Correct	Money math uses decimals and builds a life skill with authentic materials.
C	Adjacent category	Keeps the skills apart; embedding means teaching them together.
D	Camouflage	Uses the concert detail and drops the decimal standard.

Triage grid

Write each item number in the box it belongs to.

	Right	Wrong
Sure	Owned.	Concept inversion — top priority. A wrong mental model; it survives rewording.
Unsure / guess	Recognition, not mastery. Re-drill with the transfer.	Not learned yet.

Trap tally

For every miss, find the letter you chose in the key and tally its trap. The biggest number is the pattern to drill.

Trap	What it does	In this drill	Your misses
Dropped element	Leaves out a required term or step.	5	
Wrong stem number	A figure copied from the prompt that is not the answer.	0	
Adjacent category	The right idea in the wrong bucket.	5	
Inverted operation	Direction flipped: add/subtract, cause/effect, higher/lower.	7	
Absolute language	Always, never, guarantee — where judgment applies.	5	
Confusion set	Every option is real; the test is exact role-matching.	6	
Camouflage	Answers a stem fact that was never the question.	8	

Anchor rows — the concept list

One row per concept: the rule to lock in, the trap that catches people, and the tell in the question that signals it.

#	Concept	Rule	Trap	Tell
1	Specially designed instruction (SDI)	SDI means adapting the content, method, or delivery of instruction to meet a student's disability-related needs so the student can access the general curriculum.	Thinking that providing accommodations or a quieter seat by itself is special education instruction.	"What makes this special education rather than an accommodation?"
2	Skill deficit vs. performance deficit	If a student cannot do the skill even with strong incentives, teach it (skill deficit); if the student can but does not, change motivation and conditions (performance deficit).	Reteaching a skill the student already shows under the right conditions.	The student does the task in one setting or for a reward but not in another.
3	Choice-making as engagement	Building real choices (task order, materials, response mode) into lessons raises engagement and reduces problem behavior without lowering the goal.	Offering choices about whether to do the work at all.	A student resists a task that is within reach and the question asks for a first adjustment.
4	Gifts and favors from families	Decline or report gifts of more than token value and any gift tied to a decision, because they create a conflict of interest.	Accepting any gift offered kindly as long as it is not cash.	A family offers something of real value near an IEP, grading, or placement decision.
5	Burnout warning signs	Burnout shows as emotional exhaustion, depersonalization (cynicism toward students), and a falling sense of accomplishment; it calls for early action and support.	Treating cynicism about students as a normal sign of experience.	A teacher starts describing students as cases or problems and feels drained every day.
6	Professional learning networks	Ongoing growth comes from a chosen network of colleagues, organizations, and sources that you use to solve real problems of practice.	Equating professional growth with completing required one-time workshops.	"How can the teacher keep growing after the placement ends?"
7	Trying a new method with an AB comparison	To judge a new method, collect baseline data (A), then data with the method (B), changing only one thing, and compare level and trend.	Starting the new method and several other changes at once, or skipping baseline.	"How will the teacher know whether the new method worked?"
8	Embedding functional skills in academics	Relevance rises when functional life skills (money, time, reading signs, requesting help) are taught inside academic lessons with real materials.	Teaching functional skills only as a separate activity unrelated to class content.	A lesson could use real-world materials to serve both a standard and a life-skill goal.

Course scope (public description): Student Teaching II is the final part of a two-part series and is a mandatory course for all candidates seeking initial licensure. The course offers a supervised classroom experience in a real-world setting, allowing candidates to demonstrate professional ethics and dispositions, collaborate with

experienced teachers, and implement instructional strategies. Building on the responsibilities and skills developed in Student Teaching I, candidates receive ongoing feedback through observations and a final evaluation. This evaluation assesses activities' relevance and cultural engagement, the effectiveness of teaching each student, the ability to analyze and adjust teaching methods, and the willingness to explore new materials and methods. Successful completion of Student Teaching II is a crucial step in the licensure process, as it determines eligibility for licensure as a professional educator. Additionally, the course features synchronous learning sessions that delve into professional development topics such as professional growth opportunities, ethical decision making, and self-care. Candidates must attend the required synchronous learning sessions in addition to their classroom placement.